



Global Physical AI

Global Markets Research

19 May 2026

EQUITY: AUTOS & AUTO PARTS

Humanoid commercialization

How Boston Dynamics and Figure AI are de-risking the scaling playbook

Since our [February anchor report](#), the investment thesis for Physical AI has shifted from technical viability to commercial scalability. Breakthroughs in mid-May 2026 – specifically as seen in Boston Dynamics' (unlisted) investor presentation (May 18) and Figure AI's (unlisted) six-consecutive days' autonomous endurance showcase (started on May 14) – shows that the industry has crossed the chasm from R&D cost centers to scalable operational assets. Our key takeaway from the two events is clear: the industry is rapidly nearing deployment of humanoids at logistics and industrial sites, and the market is moving into a winner-take-all race driven by mass production unit economics and proprietary data flywheels.

Boston Dynamics (Hyundai): De-risking manufacturing and securing backlogs

Boston Dynamics' May 18 presentation in Boston outlined a highly disciplined, commercially mature strategy for its all-electric Atlas model, addressing historical investor concerns regarding high BOM and bespoke engineering.

- **BOM reduction via component standardization:** To unlock true mass production margins, Boston Dynamics has consolidated its complex hydraulic history into just two types of standardized commercial actuators across the entire robot. This drastically simplifies supply chain dependencies and reduces manufacturing capex.
- **The payload and adaptability breakthrough:** In the May 18 demonstration, Atlas utilized whole-body control to lift and transport a 23kg (50lbs) mini-refrigerator. In training, the underlying Reinforcement Learning (RL) model successfully scaled to handle weights up to 45kg (100lbs), proving the software's resilience against weight variations. The hardware payload capacity allows it to target heavy-duty industrial tasks (like automotive parts sequencing and steel knitting) that lighter competitors cannot touch.

Figure AI's logistics showcase and the commercial flywheel

While Boston Dynamics proves heavy-payload capability (up to 50kg), Figure AI is demonstrating the exact operational endurance required to replace human shifts at scale.

- **Logistics as the near-term TAM unlock:** While automotive giants serve as high-profile validation partners, logistics fulfillment centers represent an immediate, massive total addressable market (TAM). Automotive lines require millimeter-level precision and carry immense safety/liability friction, while logistics (picking, sorting, placing) features a lower precision threshold but infinite volume. For companies such as Coupang (CPNG US, Buy), transitioning from human labor to Robot-as-a-Service (RaaS) models will compress variable opex and permanently insulate margins from labor-intensive models.
- **The 'BotQ' factory unit economics:** Figure AI has successfully scaled production from one unit per day to one robot per hour (an annualized run-rate capability of 12k+ units). By transitioning from low-volume machining to automotive-grade high-volume die-casting, they are rapidly driving down the marginal cost per robot.
- **Operational de-risking at BMW:** Figure AI humanoids completed an 11-month field deployment at BMW's (BMW GR, Not rated) Spartanburg plant, autonomously moving 90k+ critical components with zero teleoperation. This multi-quarter data point severely de-risks the long-term investment requirements.

Research Analysts

Korea Autos & Auto Parts

Angela Hong - NFIK

angela.hong@nomura.com

+822 3783 2360

South Korea Internet & New Media

Won Kang - NFIK

won.kang@nomura.com

+822 3783 2316

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Fig. 1: Global humanoid comparison

Manufacturer	Boston Dynamics	Tesla	UBTECH Robotics	Unitree Robotics	Figure AI	Apptronik	Agility
Humanoid	Atlas	Optimus Gen-3	Walker S2	H2	Figure 03	Apollo	Digit
Price	na	USD20-30k (target)	USD68k-120k	USD30k	USD20k	USD50k (target)	USD250k (pilot)
Number of actuators	31	na	na	na	na	na	na
Key suppliers	- Hyundai Mobis (actuator) - LG Innotek (vision system) - NVIDIA (compute) - DeepMind (AI model) - Samsung SDI (battery)	- Tuopu, Sanhua (actuator) - Shuanghuan, Nidec, Leaderdrive, Slin (reducer) - Moons' Electric, Fengqiu Technology (motor) - Lingyun (torque sensor) - SEMCO (camera module) - Samsung Elec (compute) - xAI (AI model) - LGES (battery)	- In-house actuator - NVIDIA (compute) - Huawei (AI model)	- In-house actuator - Intel (processor/camera) - Livox (LiDAR) - Orbbec (vision) - Dingzhi Tech. (Motor) - NVIDIA (compute) - DeepSeek (AI model)	- In-house actuator - LG Innotek (camera module) - NVIDIA (compute) - OpenAI (AI model)	- In-house actuator - Texas Instruments (motor control system) - NVIDIA (compute) - DeepMind (AI model)	- In-house actuator - Intel (camera) - NVIDIA (compute) - AWS (cloud infra)
Degrees of Freedom	56	40+	52	31	30+	71	28
Payload (kg)	50	20	15	15	20	25	16
Height (cm)	190	173	176	182	172	173	175
Weight (kg)	90	57	70	70	61	73	65
Walking speed (km/h)	9	8	7.2	5.4	4.3	3.4	5
Run time	4 hours	12 hours	2 hours	3 hours	5 hours	4 hours	4 hours
Auto OEM partner	HMG	In-house	BYD, Geely, NIO	Dongfeng	BMW	Mercedes-Benz	Toyota
Others	Max. reach of 2.3m	-	Max. reach of 1.8m	-	3-second cycle time for parcel sorting	-	-

Source: Company data, Robozaps, Nomura research

Fig. 2: Major humanoid companies — funding rounds and valuations

Company	Date	Funding Round	Capital Raised	Valuation	Major Investors
Boston Dynamics	Jun-21	Acquisition	USD880mn	USD1.1bn	Hyundai Motor Group
	Jun-17	Acquisition	USD100mn	USD100mn	Softbank Group
	Dec-13	Acquisition	undisclosed	undisclosed	Google
Raiwnbow Robotics	Dec-24	Secondary share acquisition via call option exercise	KRW267.5bn	KRW1.3tn	Samsung Electronics
	1Q23	Initial equity investment	KRW86.8bn	KRW590bn	Samsung Electronics
	Feb-21	IPO	KRW26.5bn	KRW100bn	-
Figure AI	May-25	Series C	USD1.5bn	USD39bn	Park Venture Capital, Intel Capital, Salesforce, Samsung NEXT ventures
	Feb-24	Series B	USD675mn	USD2.6bn	NVIDIA, Microsoft, Bezos Expedition, OpenAI, LG Technology Ventures
	May-23	Series A	USD70mn	USD400mn	Parkway Venture Capital
Appttronik	Feb-26	Series A	USD935mn	USD5.3bn	B Capital Group, Capital Factory, Google, Mercedes-Benz Group, Samsung NEXT ventures
	Feb-23	Seed Round	USD13.9mn	USD109mn	Terex, Berch Capital and WorldQuant Ventures
	May-22	Seed Round	USD14.4mn	USD59.4mn	Grit Ventures, Perot Jain, Capital Factory
Agility Robotics	Jun-25	Series C3	USD400mn	USD2.15bn	WP Global Partners, Kirra Global, Palo Alto Capital
	Oct-24	Series C	USD105mn	USD955mn	Amazon Industrial Innovation Fund, Schaeffler Group USA, Gaingels
	Apr-22	Series B	USD150mn	USD550mn	Playground Global, DCVC
	Oct-20	Later Stage VC (Series A)	USD20mn	USD50mn	Playground Global, DCVC
	Feb-18	Early Stage VC (Series A)	USD8mn	USD25mn	Sony Innovation Fund, Coal Hill Ventures, Playground Global
Unitree	Jun-25	Series C	USD97mn	USD1.7bn	China Mobile, Tencent holdings, Alibaba Group, Geely Capital
	Feb-24	Series B	USD140mn	-	Gold Stone Investment
	Feb-21	Series A	USD10mn	-	Shunwei Capital

Source: Company data, Nomura research

Appendix A-1

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